

RICHARD DILLMAN

Leader | Mentor | SEO | Performance

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SUMMARY

Engineering leader with a track record of modernizing front-end systems using React and TypeScript, achieving 95+ Lighthouse scores and 50% conversion rate boosts. Passionate about creating seamless user experiences and mentoring teams to drive impactful results in high-traffic environments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

THE MUSE | REMOTE | DECEMBER 2018 – SEPTEMBER 2025

Senior Director of Engineering (progression: Sr Engineer → Staff → Director → Sr Director)

Directed end-to-end engineering strategy for a high-traffic career platform serving millions of users. Established code standards, CI/CD pipelines, SEO and performance frameworks, and analytics instrumentation that unified frontend and backend development.

- Rebuilt platform in **Next.js, React, and TypeScript**, driving Lighthouse scores from **40 to 95+** and cutting bundle sizes 80%
- Rebuilt CI/CD pipelines reducing deploy times from **45+ minutes to 75 seconds**, enabling rapid iteration and A/B testing
- Delivered **10x organic traffic growth** through performance optimization and structured data implementation
- Architected white-label multi-tenant job platform, opening **\$153K-\$230K annual revenue per tenant**
- Optimized PostgreSQL queries, added strategic indexes, and implemented caching layers (Redis), reducing page load times from **3.5s to 800ms**
- Shipped Next.js infrastructure template used by **4 teams**, cutting project kickoff from **2 weeks to 2 hours** and standardizing build pipelines
- Increased **SEO traffic by 74K monthly visits** and **applications per user by 50%** through UX redesign

CONDÉ NAST | NEW YORK, NY | JULY 2015 – NOVEMBER 2018

Senior Ad-Tech Engineer (Career progression: Sr Frontend → Sr Software → Sr Ad-Tech)

Owned architecture and delivery of a cross-brand ad tech platform spanning 30+ Condé Nast properties. Unified multiple legacy back- and front-end systems into a scalable ad delivery framework serving 229 million users monthly.

- Rebuilt **cross-brand ad delivery infrastructure** using Node.js microservices and React, increasing ad visibility from **45% to 85%** and revenue by **\$2M+ annually** (equivalent to **\$994K annual yield improvement**)
- Unified React-Node services with standardized deployment and shared components across 30+ brand properties (Vogue, GQ, Wired, Vanity Fair, The New Yorker)
- Developed **RESTful APIs** for programmatic ad bidding, real-time auction systems, and analytics, handling **1B+ monthly requests**
- Optimized backend pipelines for **1B+ monthly video views**, implementing caching strategies, CDN integration, and load balancing
- Achieved **80%+ test coverage** using Jest, Mocha, and integration testing frameworks, establishing testing standards and authoring RFCs across engineering teams

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Everyday Health:** Scaled consumer health platforms reaching 30 M+ monthly users across Everyday Health, What to Expect, and MedPage Today, ensuring compliant (HIPAA, COPPA, CCPA, GDPR) data handling and strong SEO and page speed performance.
- **CatalpaSoft (Founder):** Delivered secure ColdFusion and MSSQL solutions for state foster-care agencies, digitizing workflows for 12 000+ children and 3000 households while meeting government data-security and compliance standards.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Frontend:** React.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Next.js, SCSS, CSS Modules, Tailwind, Storybook, ShadCN
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express.js, Koa, Python, RESTful APIs, GraphQL, FastAPI, Django
- **Database:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, NoSQL/DynamoDB, MS SQL, Redis, Prisma
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (Lambda, RDS, S3, API Gateway), Docker, CI/CD pipelines (CircleCI, Jenkins, Github Actions), Cloudflare, Infrastructure as Code
- **Analytics & Observability:** Snowplow, Datadog, Looker, Redshift, Google Analytics, Statsig, Core Web Vitals, Google Search Console, GA4, GTM
- **General:** Git, Agile/Scrum, microservices architecture, serverless, event-driven systems, performance optimization, mentoring, SEO